Jeongdam Choi

Curriculum Vitae, Oct 14 2026

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Current Status

M.S. student in Symbolic Systems at Stanford University. (’26 - ’28)

Intended Areas of Specialization

Philosophy of Logic, Philosophy of Language

Broader Interests

Foundations of Mathematics, Philosophy of Mathematics, Philosophy of Mind, Philosophy of Physics

Education

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (2020-2024, GPA: 4.08/4.3)
Bachelor’s Degree: Department of Mathematical Sciences, Double Major in School of Computing

University of Leeds (2022/2023 Semester, Credits: 32.5 ECTS)
Study Abroad: Philosophy, Religion and History of Science

Awards and Scholarships

Summa cum laude (KAIST, 2024)

KAIST Presidential Fellowship (KAIST, 2022)
In recognition of their broad and profound academic curiosity, and their ability to channel it through writing that inspires in others an appreciation of deliberation.

Presidential Science Scholarship (President of South Korea, 2020)

Talent Award of Korea (Minister of Education, 2019)
In recognition of their outstanding performance in mathematics and computer science, and their commitment to making learning accessible and enjoyable through social platforms.

Experience

Republic of Korea Air Force IT Development & Management Specialist (2024-2026)
In fulfillment of mandatory military service, developed new systems including the Uniform e-Shop System and the Catering Attendance Survey System, and maintained existing systems including the Physical Fitness Assessment System, using Spring and React.

Assistance in Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence Research (2024)
Assisted Prof. Dongwoo Kim and Prof. Hyungrae Noh in research on the public’s ethico-epistemological attitudes towards artificial intelligence. Authored questionnaires and contributed to research discussions.

Exchange Student at Yonsei University (2022, GPA: 4.3/4.3)
Studied analytic philosophy under Prof. Lee Seungjong.

Internship at PLRG @ KAIST (2022-2023)
Led a study group on programming language theory and program analysis. Organised reading sessions on key papers in programming language theory. Assisted in the implementation of a static analyser for JavaScript.

Activities

Blog on Logic, Mathematics, and Philosophy
Topics range from technical areas—model theory, foundations, topology—to more interpretive subjects, including philosophical expositions and literary translation. (Written in both English & Korean)

Topics on Logic and Philosophy of Language (2024)
Independently prepared and delivered a semester-long lecture series. Lecture notes have been bookmarked by over 2,000 users on X (formerly Twitter).

Published Books, Essays, and Series

Glass and Mist《수학이 가르쳐 준 세계》 (2026, Seosamdok)
ㅁ collection of personal essays on logic and language. Recommeded by Minhyong Kim, Christopher Zeeman Professor of Algebra, Geometry, and Public Understanding of Mathematics.

How to Read Maths《수학을 읽는 힘》 (2025, Woongjin)
An illustrated history of mathematics and its ties to philosophy and science. Recommended by the Ministry of Education for young readers.

Lessons from Mathematics「수학이 그렇게 말했다」 (2024, Jihak Publishing Co.)
A collection of essays interweaving the intellectual virtues of mathematics with humanistic inquiry.

Russell: Mathematics, Philosophy, and Life「러셀 탐구생활」 (2023, Donga Science)
A brief biography of Bertrand Russell, along with personal thoughts on the public duty of intellectuals.

Alice in Logicland「역설 나라의 앨리스」 (2022, Donga Science)
An exposition of logical paradoxes and their connection to the foundations of mathematics.

A Subversive Guide to Maths《발칙한 수학책》 (2021, Whalebooks)
An exposition of pure mathematics, highlighting the logical structure of mathematical language and the intricate network of concepts it builds. Named best-selling science book of the year, currently 14th ed.

Writing Samples

Can Natural Teleology Ground Logic? (2025)
Argues that the indeterminacy problem on which Dennett's skepticism about semantic realism relies does not in itself undermine realism; and second, that the natural-teleological account about meaning, when subjected to logic, is question-begging for its appeal to the notion of truth, which the Tarskian analysis reveals to presuppose definite meanings for each logical connective.

Semantic Criticism of Multiple Realisability (2023)
Argues that the scope of Fodor's multiple realizability argument is more limited than he claims. Drawing on the use theory of meaning, the essay contends that many purported cases of multiple realisability are in fact pseudo-natural kinds. Concludes that multiple realisability highlights the need for refined kinds, but does not preclude the effectiveness of reduction.

Remarks on the Naturalistic Account of Wittgensteinian Philosophy of Mathematics (2022)
Summarises Lee Seungjong's interpretation of Wittgenstein's philosophy of mathematics, focusing on the naturalisation of logic, contradictions, and mathematics. Offers commentary on logic and contradictions through discussions of modality and Thompson's lamp. Criticises Lee's discussion on mathematics by identifying a fallacy in his use of non-Euclidean geometry to exemplify the alleged irreconcilability of distinct mathematical theories.

Miscellaneous Skills

Language
Native in Korean, fluent in English (C1-C2), acquainted with Japanese (JLPT N2) and German (B1).

Web Development
Capable of fullstack development, including Java, Spring, SQL, JavaScript, React, HTML/CSS.